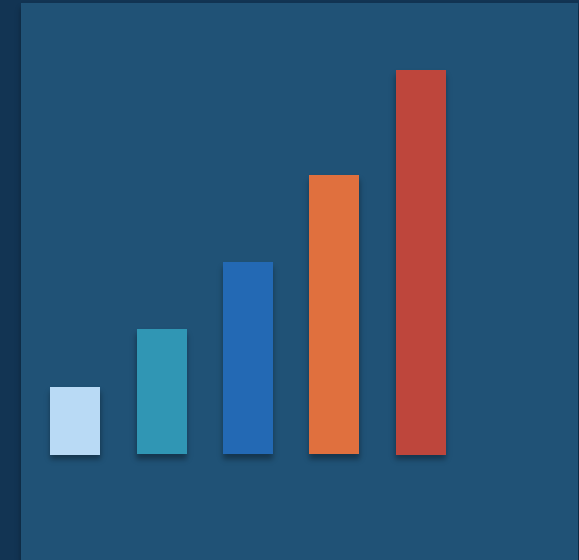


Global CO₂ Emissions: Who Emits, How Much, and What's Changing

Fossil fuels & industry · 1750–2024

A data-driven overview for policy analysts, climate negotiators, and sustainability researchers.



Data attribution
Global Carbon Budget 2025
via Our World in Data

Scope: annual CO₂ emissions by country, region, and per person

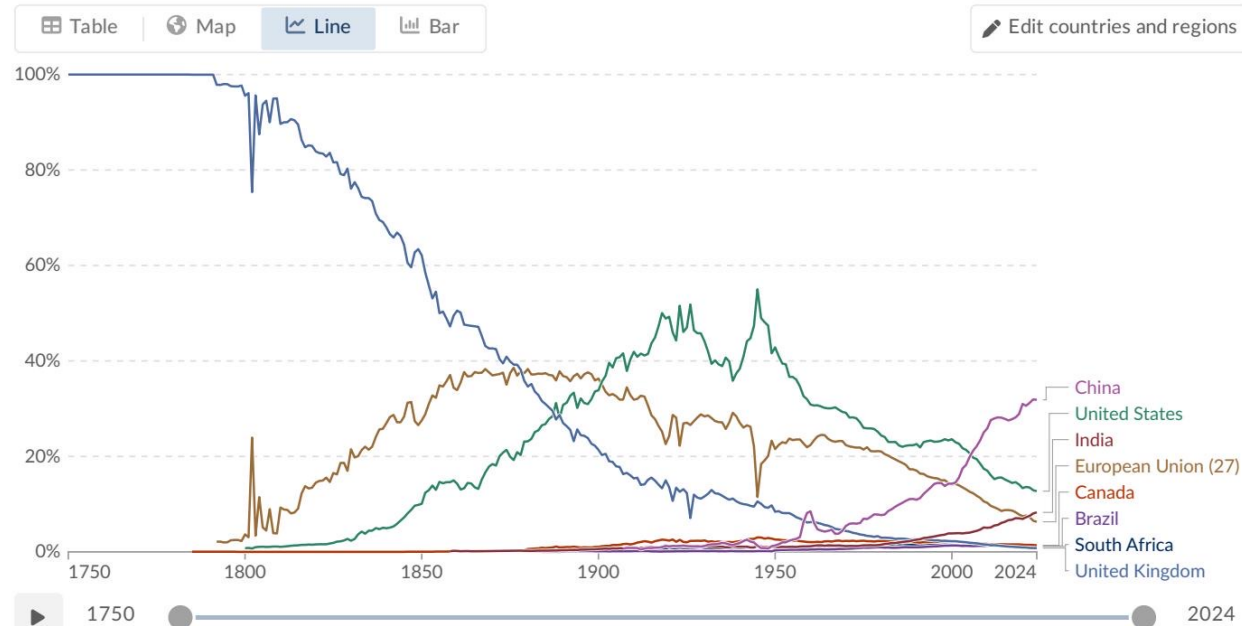
Global CO₂ Emissions Grew from 6 Bt in 1950 to Over 35 Bt Today

Long-run fossil-fuel and industrial emissions show three phases: negligible pre-industrial levels, rapid post-1950 acceleration, and slower recent growth without a peak.

Share of global CO₂ emissions

Carbon dioxide (CO₂) emissions from fossil fuels and industry. Land-use change emissions are not included.

Our World
in Data



Data source: Global Carbon Budget (2025) – [Learn more about this data](#)
OurWorldinData.org/co2-and-greenhouse-gas-emissions | CC BY

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1950
~6 Bt/yr

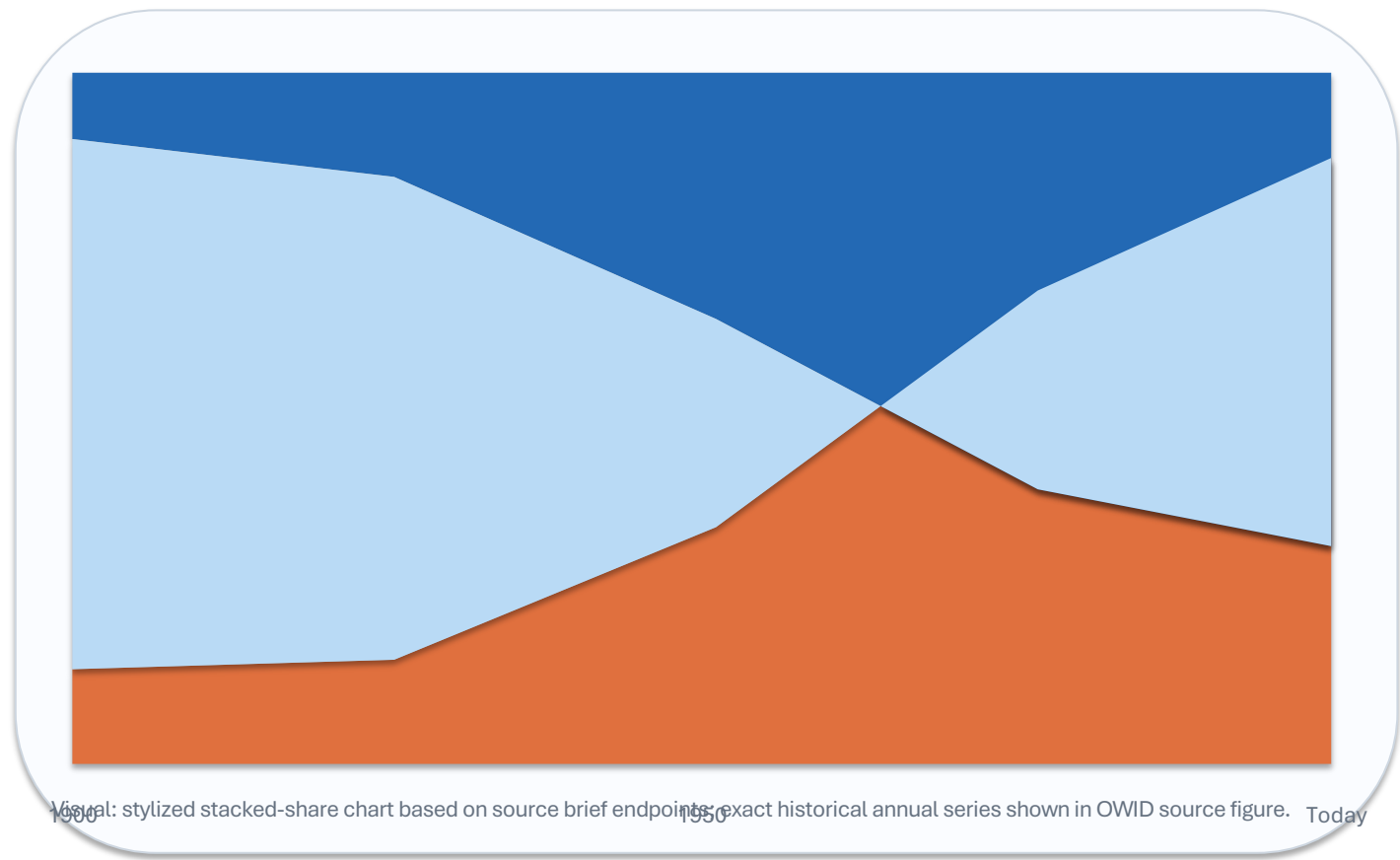
1990
>20 Bt/yr

Today
>35 Bt/yr

Annotated inflection points from source brief. The trajectory remains upward: growth has slowed recently, but global CO₂ emissions have not yet peaked.

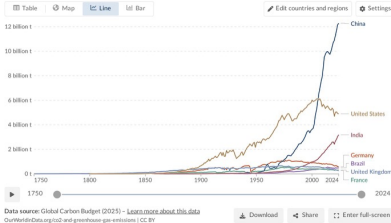
Europe and the US Fell from 90% of Emissions in 1900 to Under One-Third Today

The geography of annual emissions shifted from industrialized Europe and North America toward Asia, led by China.



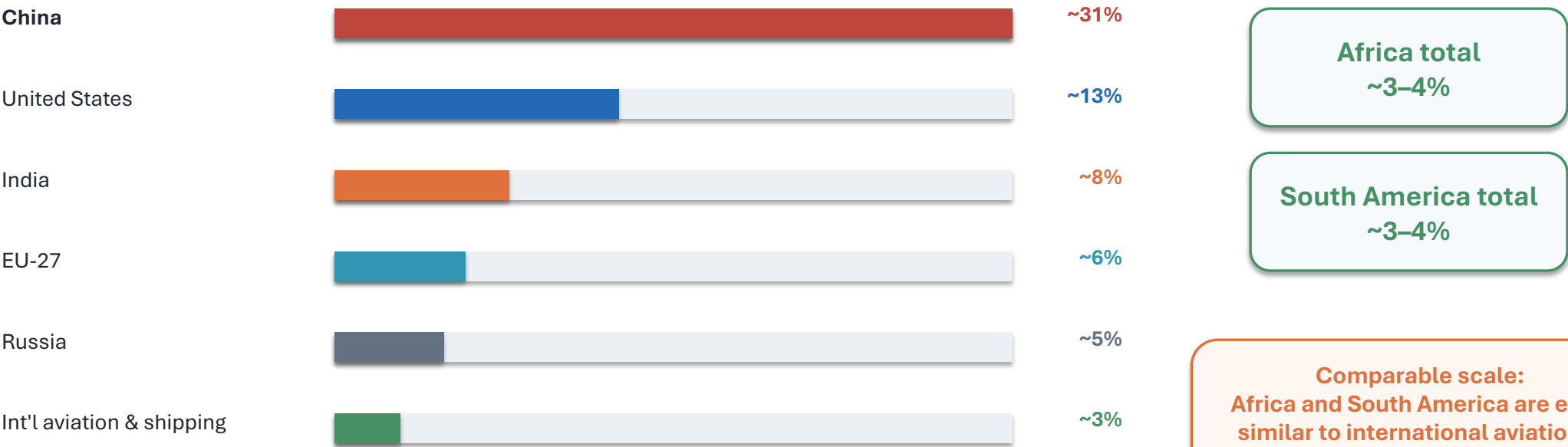
Europe + US
>90% in 1900
>85% in 1950
<1/3 today

Asia now produces
roughly half
of global emissions



China Now Emits More Than One-Quarter of Global CO₂

Annual emissions are highly concentrated: China alone accounts for about one-third of global CO₂, with the US a distant second.

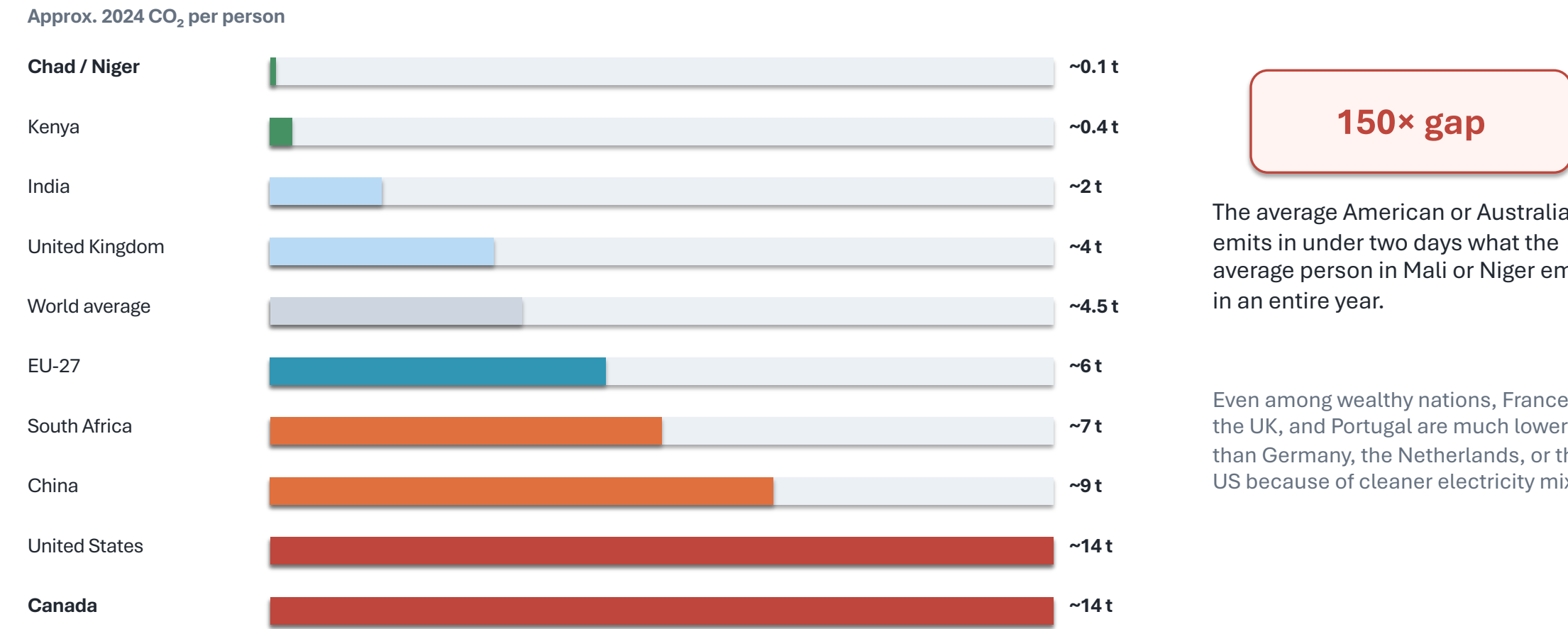


Comparable scale:
Africa and South America are each similar to international aviation & shipping combined.

Trend signals from source table: China and India rising; US and EU declining; Russia roughly stable; international aviation & shipping rising.

Per Capita Emissions Range from 0.1 t in Chad to ~14 t in the US and Canada

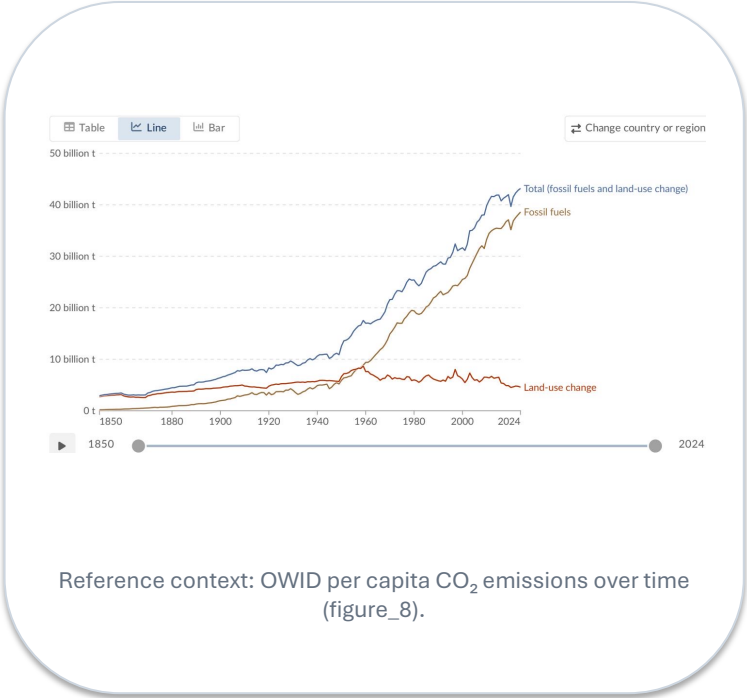
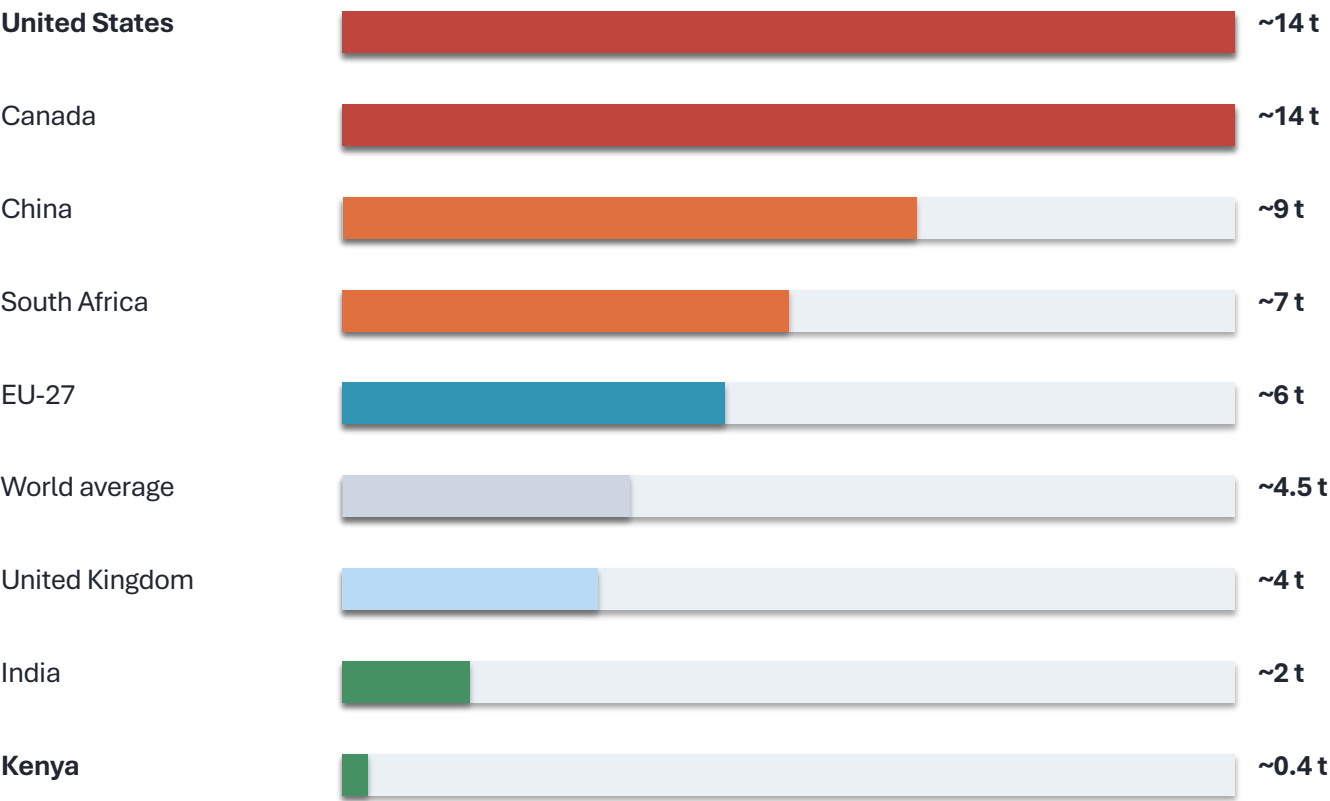
Per-person emissions reframe responsibility: a small group of high-income countries emit vastly more per person than the lowest-emitting countries.



Per Capita Emissions Vary Widely: ~14 t in the US vs. ~9 t in China and ~2 t in India

Largest annual emitters are not necessarily the largest per-person emitters; China remains well below US and Canada on a per capita basis.

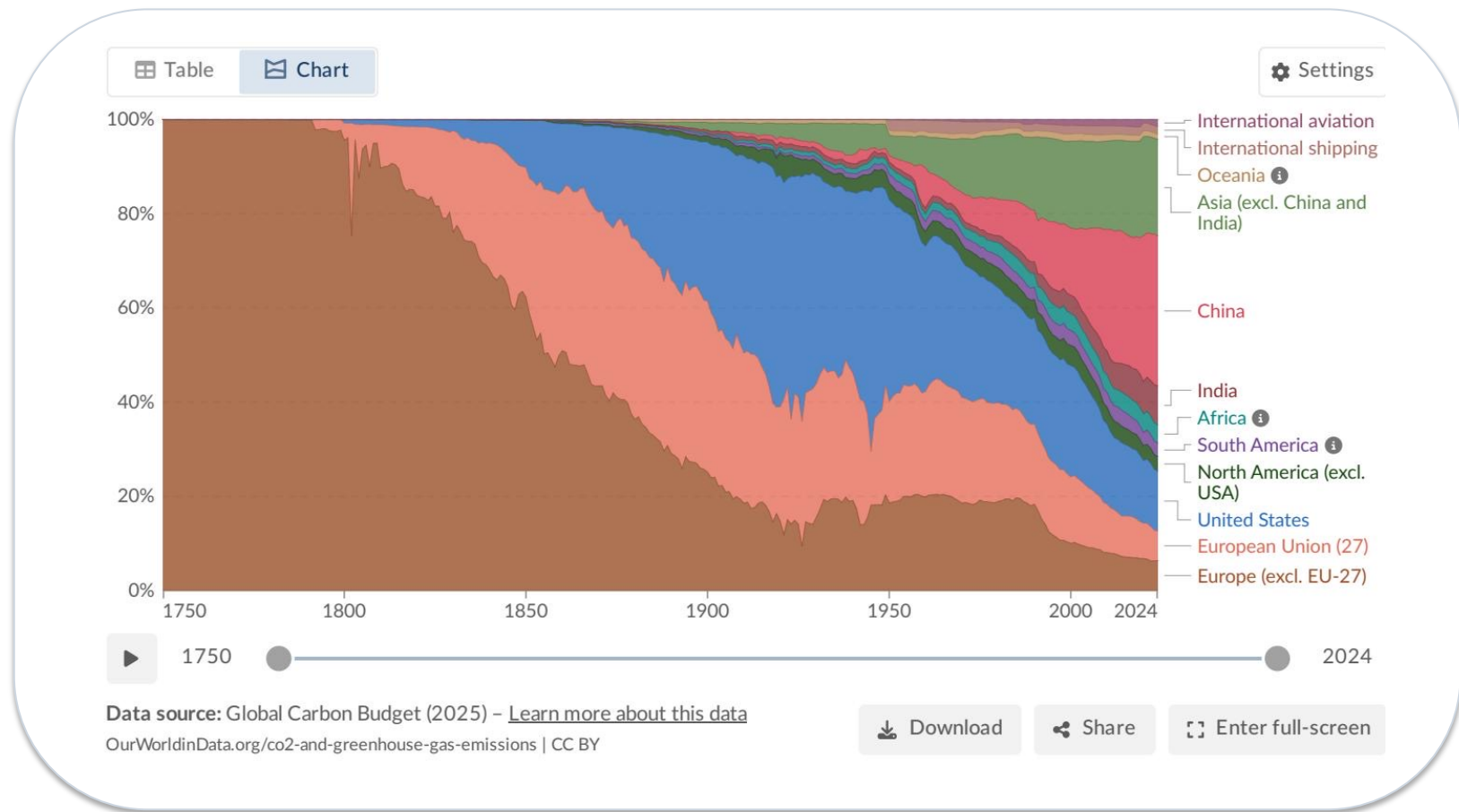
Current per capita comparison



China: largest total emitter, but ~9 t/person

2024 Snapshot: Many Western Nations Cut Emissions While Parts of Asia and Africa Grew

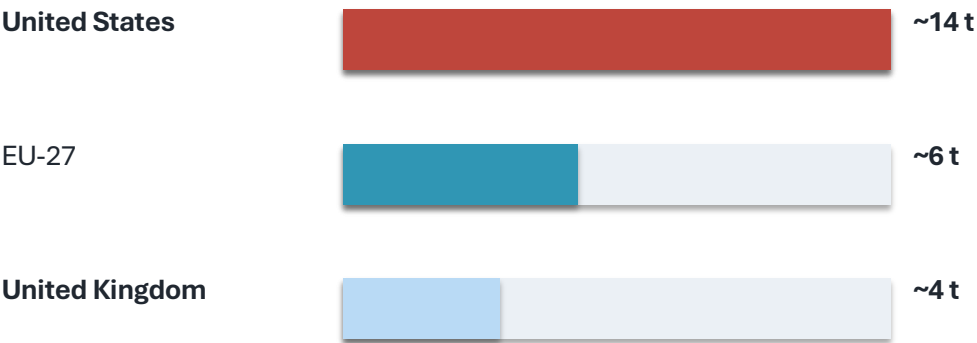
Annual percentage change shows a mixed picture: reductions across many developed economies, with increases in several emerging and resource-producing regions.



Energy Mix Explains Why France and the UK Emit Far Less Per Capita Than Germany or the US

Among wealthy nations with similar prosperity levels, per capita emissions differ sharply because electricity systems rely on different mixes of fossil fuels, nuclear, and renewables.

Available per capita anchors from source brief



Lower per capita

France, the UK, and Portugal

Higher per capita

Germany, the Netherlands, and the US

Driver

Higher nuclear and renewable electricity share lowers fossil-fuel emissions

This slide intentionally avoids a detailed energy-breakdown chart because the source brief provides qualitative energy-mix findings, not country-level energy-share values.

Key Takeaways:

Responsibility Is Shared but Unequal

- **No peak yet** Global fossil-fuel and industrial CO₂ emissions exceed 35 Bt/yr and have not yet peaked.
- **Annual dominance shifted** China is the largest annual emitter; Europe and the US fell from historical dominance to under one-third today.
- **Per capita changes the lens** China is ~9 t/person versus ~14 t in the US and Canada; India remains ~2 t/person.
- **Inequality remains extreme** A 150× gap persists between the lowest emitters and the highest large-country emitters.
- **Policy choices matter** Energy policy and technology choices can decouple prosperity from emissions.

Policy implication
Mitigation is global, but fair burden-sharing must account for history, scale, and per-person emissions.